



START SMALL. FEED STEADILY. WATCH IT GROW.

The Home Baker's Sourdough Starter Guide

A calm, practical starting point for building a wild-yeast starter, spotting when it is ready, and avoiding three common early stumbles.

YOUR FOUR-PAGE FIELD NOTE

From the bakers at Cook & Bake Academy Singapore

01 / FEEDING SCHEDULE

Give your starter a steady rhythm.

A starter responds to warmth, flour, water and time. Use this as a simple room-temperature baseline, then follow the signs in the jar.

1

DAY 1

Mix

Combine 30 g whole-wheat or rye flour with 30 g water in a clean jar. Stir until no dry flour remains. Cover loosely and leave at room temperature.

2

DAYS 2-7

Refresh daily

Keep 30 g starter; discard the rest. Stir in 30 g water, then 30 g flour. Mark the level with a band or marker and note the time.

3

AFTER DAY 7

Keep or chill

When it rises predictably after feeding, keep it at room temperature and feed daily, or refrigerate and refresh about weekly. Bring it back to room temperature and feed before baking.

Look for the pattern, not the clock. A warm kitchen speeds fermentation; a cool one slows it. If you see no activity after a week, keep the daily refresh going and check that the jar is not cold.

02 / READY TO BAKE?

Three signs your starter is ready.

Read these together over several feedings. One lively moment is encouraging; a repeatable rise is more useful.

01 It rises predictably

After a feed, it grows to about double its starting height within roughly 4-8 hours in a comfortably warm room.

02 The top is lively

You can see bubbles throughout the sides and surface. The texture looks aerated rather than like a flat paste.

03 It smells pleasantly tangy

Expect a fresh, yoghurty or fruity sour smell. A sharp acetone note often means it is hungry: refresh it and watch again.

03 / THREE COMMON STARTER STUMBLES

1

Changing the routine too soon

Keep the same flour, ratio and timing for several days so you can read what changed.

2

Using a tight lid

Fermentation needs room for gas to escape. Rest a lid loosely on top; do not seal an active jar.

3

Expecting a fixed timetable

Temperature changes the pace. Feed consistently and use the rise, bubbles and aroma as your guide.

Safety note: Pink or orange streaks, fuzzy growth, or a rotten smell mean discard the starter and clean the jar. When in doubt, start again.

04 / YOUR NEXT LOAF

A starter is only the beginning.

Build confidence with a loaf, then learn how to mix, fold, shape, proof and bake at home.

YOU ARE INVITED

Cook & Bake Open House

Saturday 14 November 2026, 10am-4pm

Free entry at both campuses. Drop in for live demos every hour and taste what learners make.

Find open-house RSVP details at alfredang.github.io/codex-demo.

BAK-101 / ARTISAN SOURDOUGH BREAD BAKING

Next intake: Saturday 5 December 2026

A four-week beginner course with one three-hour, hands-on session each week. Practise starter care, stretch-and-fold, shaping, proofing, scoring and baking in a home oven with a Dutch oven. Class size: up to 12 learners. Fee: S\$680, including ingredients and equipment.

Bring a 1-litre jar for your starter. Learn more about BAK-101 on the academy site, or email enrol@cookbakeacademy.sg with the course code.

LEARN IT. MAKE IT YOURS.